

0.0.1 Sela

selasuttam

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One while wandering on tour in Anguttarapa with a large Sangha of bhikkhus, with one thousand, two hundred and fifty bhikkhus, arrived at a market town of Anguttarapa called Apana. Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, heard: “The Master Gotama, son of the Sakyans, having gone forth from the Sakyan clan, has arrived at Apana. Now a good reputation has been spread about that Auspicious Gotama thus: “Truly is he the Auspicious One, the Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious.” Having realized this world with its devas, maras and brahmas, together with the population of samanas and brahmanas, devas and humans, he causes to make it known. He teaches the Dhamma that is good in the beginning, good in the middle, good in the end, with the right meaning and phrasing, making known the life of purity that is utterly perfect and pure. Now good is the sight of such arahants.”

evam me sutam: ekam samayam bhagava anguttarapesu carikam caramano mahata bhikkhusanghena saddhim adhatasehi bhikkhusatehi, yena appanam nama anguttarappanam nigamo tadavasari. assosi kho keniyo jatilo samano khalu bho

gotamo sakyaputto sakyakulā pabbajito aṅgutta-
rāpesu cārikaṃ caramāno mahatā bhikkhusaṅghena
saddhiṃ aḍḍhatelasehi bhikkhusatehi āpaṇaṃ anup-
patto. taṃ kho pana bhagavantam gotamaṃ evaṃ
kalyāṇo kittisaddo abbhuggato: ‘itipi so bhagavā
arahaṃ sammāsambuddho vijjācaraṇasampanno
sugato lokavidū anuttaro purisadammasārathi sat-
thā devamanussānaṃ buddho bhagavāti. so imaṃ
lokaṃ sadevakaṃ samārakaṃ sabrahmakaṃ sas-
samaṇabrāhmaṇiṃ pajam sadevamanussaṃ sayam
abhiññā sacchikatvā pavedeti. so dhammaṃ de-
seti ādikalyāṇaṃ majjhakalyāṇaṃ pariyosānakal-
yāṇaṃ sātthaṃ sabyañjanaṃ kevalaparipuṇṇaṃ
parisuddhaṃ brahmacariyaṃ pakāseti. sādhu kho
pana tathārūpaṇaṃ arahataṃ dassanaṃ hotī’ti.

2. Then Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, he exchanged friendly greetings with the Auspicious One. Having exchange friendly greetings and cordial talk, he sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the Auspicious One instructed, aroused, energized, gladdened Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, with a Dhamma talk. Then Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, having been instructed, aroused, energized, gladdened with a Dhamma talk, said this to the Auspicious One. “May Master Gotama, together with the bhikkhu sangha, consent to [accepting] tomorrow’s meal from me.” When thus was said, the Auspicious One said this to Keniya, the matted hair ascetic: “Large,

O Keniya, is the bhikkhu sangha, one thousand, two hundred and fifty, and you place higher faith in the brahmins.” Also for a second time, Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, said this to the Auspicious One. “May Master Gotama, together with the bhikkhu sangha, consent to [accepting] tomorrow’s meal from me.” Also for a second time, the Auspicious One said this to Keniya, the matted hair ascetic: “Large, O Keniya, is the bhikkhu sangha, one thousand, two hundred and fifty, and you place higher faith in the brahmins.” Also for a third time, Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, said this to the Auspicious One. “May Master Gotama, together with the bhikkhu sangha, consent to [accepting] tomorrow’s meal from me.” The Auspicious One consented by silence.

atha kho keṇiyo jaṭilo yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavatā saddhiṃ sammodi. sammodanīyaṃ kathaṃ sārāṇīyaṃ vītisāretvā ekamantaṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ nisinnaṃ kho keṇiyaṃ jaṭilaṃ bhagavā dhammiyā kathāya sandassesi samādapesi samuttejesi sampahaṃsesi. atha kho keṇiyo jaṭilo bhagavatā dhammiyā kathāya sandassito samādapito samuttejito sampahaṃsito bhagavantam etadavoca: ‘adhivāsetu me bhavaṃ gotamo svātanāya bhattam saddhiṃ bhikkhusaṅghenā’ti. evaṃ vutte bhagavā keṇiyaṃ jaṭilaṃ etadavoca: mahā kho keṇiya, bhikkhusaṅgho aḍḍhateḷasāni bhikkhusatāni. tvaṅca kho brāhmaṇesu abhippasanno’ti. dutiyampi kho keṇiyo jaṭilo bhagavantam etadavoca: ‘kiñcāpi bho go-

tama, mahā bhikkhusaṅgho, aḍḍhatelaṣāni bhikkhusatāni, ahañca brāhmaṇesu abhippasanno, adhivāsetu me bhavaṃ gotamo svātanāya bhattaṃ saddhiṃ bhikkhusaṅghenā'ti. dutiyampi kho bhagavā kenīyaṃ jaṭilaṃ etadavoca: 'mahā kho kenīya, bhikkhusaṅgho aḍḍhatelaṣāni bhikkhusatāni. tvañca kho brāhmaṇesu abhippasanno'ti. tatiyampi kho kenīyo jaṭilo bhagavantam etadavoca: 'kiñcāpi bho gotama mahā bhikkhusaṅgho, aḍḍhatelaṣāni bhikkhusatāni. ahañca brāhmaṇesu abhippasanno, adhivāsetu me bhavaṃ gotamo svātanāya bhattaṃ saddhiṃ bhikkhusaṅghenā'ti. adhivāsesi bhagavā tuṇhībhāvena.

3. Then, Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, having known of the Auspicious One's consent, having risen up from his seat, stopped by his own hermitage. Upon arrival, he addressed his friends and colleagues, family and blood relations: "Hear me honorable friends and colleagues, family and blood relations. The samana Gotama, together with the bhikkhu sangha, have been invited by me for tomorrow's meal. You may provide me with physical assistance." "Yes Sir," those friends and colleagues, family and blood relations of Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, having replied, some dug out ovens, some split firewood, some washed pots, some set in place water vessels, some prepared seats, and Keniya, the matted hair ascetic himself, arranged a circular pavilion.

atha kho keṇiyo jaṭilo bhagavato adbhivāsanam vīditvā utṭhāyāsanā yena sako assamo tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā mittāmacce ñātisālohite āmanatesi: suṇantu me bhonto mittāmaccā ñātisālohitā, samaṇo me gotamo nimantito svātanāya bhaṭṭam saddhim bhikkhusaṅghena. yena me kāyaveyyāvaṭikaṃ¹ kareyyāthā'ti. evaṃ bho'ti kho keṇiyassa jaṭilassa mittāmaccā ñātisālohitā keṇiyassa jaṭilassa paṭissutvā appekacce uddhanāni khaṇanti, appekacce kaṭṭhāni phārenti, appekacce bhājanāni dhovanti, appekacce udakamaṇikaṃ paṭiṭṭhāpentī, appekacce āsanāni paññāpentī. keṇiyo pana jaṭilo sāmāññeva maṇḍalamālaṃ paṭiyādeti.

4. At that time the brahmin Sela was living at Apana, a knowledge master of the three vedas, of the vocabularies and the rituals, of the phonology and the etymology with the legends as the fifth, master of the verses and the grammar, well versed in the materialistic philosophy and the auspicious marks of a great man, and he taught the mantras to three hundred brahmin students. At that time Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, placed higher faith in the brahmin Sela. Then the brahmin Sela while walking and wandering about, accompanied by three hundred brahmin students, walking along back and forth, stopped by Keniya, the matted hair ascetic's hermitage. The brahmin Sela saw some people digging out ovens at Keniya, the matted hair ascetic's hermitage, some splitting firewood, some washing pots, some setting in place water

vessels, some preparing seats, and Keniya, the matted hair ascetic himself, arranging a circular pavilion. Having seen, he said this to Keniya, the matted hair ascetic: “Is there going to be an engagement for you, Master Keniya, or is there going to be a marriage, or an offering of a great sacrifice, or is Seniya Bimbisara, the king of Magadha, together with his army invited for tomorrow?” “No, Master Sela, there is not going to be an engagement for me, nor is there going to be a marriage, nor an offering of a great sacrifice, nor is Seniya Bimbisara, the king of Magadha, together with his army invited for tomorrow.” Rather, [there will be] an offering of a great sacrifice by me. There is, Master, the samana Gotama, son of the Sakyans, having gone forth from the Sakyan clan, while wandering on tour in Anguttarapa with a large Sangha of bhikkhus, with one thousand, two hundred and fifty bhikkhus, has arrived at Apana. Now a good reputation has been spread about that Auspicious Gotama thus: “Truly is he the Auspicious One, the Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious.” He has been invited by me, together with the bhikkhu sangha, for tomorrow’s meal.” Do you say “Buddha,” Master Keniya? I say “Buddha,” Master Sela? Do you say “Buddha,” Master Keniya? I say “Buddha,” Master Sela? Do you say “Buddha,” Master Keniya? I say “Buddha,” Master Sela?

tena kho pana samayena selo brāhmaṇo āpaṇe

paṭivasati tiṇṇaṃ vedānaṃ pāragū sanighaṇḍu-
 keṭubhānaṃ sākkharappabhedānaṃ itihāsapañ-
 camānaṃ padako veyyākaraṇo lokāyatamahāpu-
 risalakkhaṇesu anavayo. tiṇi ca māṇavakasatāni
 mante vāceti. tena kho pana samayena keṇiyo ja-
 ṭilo sele brāhmaṇe abhippasanno hoti. atha kho
 selo brāhmaṇo tihi māṇavakasatehi parivuto jaṅ-
 ghāvihāraṃ anucaṅkamamāno anuvicaramāno yena
 keṇiyassa jaṭilassa assamo tenupasaṅkami. ad-
 dasā kho selo brāhmaṇo keṇiyassa jaṭilassa as-
 same appekacce uddhanāni khaṇante, appekacce
 kaṭṭhāni phālente, appekacce bhājanāni dhovante,
 appekacce udakamaṇikaṃ patiṭṭhāpente, appekacce
 āsanāni paññāpente², keṇiyaṃ pana jaṭilaṃ sā-
 maññeva maṇḍalamālaṃ paṭiyādentam. disvāna
 keṇiyaṃ jaṭilaṃ etadavoca: kinnu bhoto keṇiyassa
 āvāho vā bhavissati, vivāho vā bhavissati, mahā-
 yañño vā paccupaṭṭhito, rājā vā māgadho seniyo
 bimbisāro nimantito svātanāya saddhiṃ balakā-
 yenā'ti. na me bho sela āvāho bhavissati, napi
 vivāho bhavissati, napi rājā māgadho seniyo bim-
 bisāro nimantito svātanāya saddhiṃ balakāyena.
 api ca kho me mahāyañño paccupaṭṭhito. atthi
 bho samaṇo gotamo sakyaputto sakyakulā pab-
 bajito āṅguttarāpesu cārikaṃ caramāno mahatā
 bhikkhusaṅghena saddhiṃ aḍḍhatelāsehi bhikkhu-
 satehi āpaṇaṃ anuppatto. taṃ kho pana bhaga-
 vantaṃ³ gotamaṃ evaṃ kalyāṇo kittisaddo ab-
 bhuggato: 'itipi so bhagavā ahaṃ sammāsam-
 buddho vijjācaraṇasampanno sugato lokavidū anut-

taro purisadammasārathi satthā devamanussānam
 buddho bhagavā'ti. so me nimantito svātanāya
 bhattam saddhiṃ bhikkhusaṅghenā'ti. buddhoti
 bho keṇiya vadesi, buddhoti bho sela vadāmi. bud-
 dhoti bho keṇiya vadesi, buddhoti bho sela va-
 dāmi. buddhoti bho keṇiya vadesi, buddhoti bho
 sela vadāmī'ti.

5. Then for the brahmin Sela, this occurred: "Even this utterance is rare in the world, namely, "Buddha." Moreover the thirty two auspicious marks of a great man has been handed down in our mantras, by which for the person endowed with those great marks, there are only two destinies, no other. If he lives the home life, he becomes a wheel turning monarch, a righteous king ruling by the dhamma, victorious king of the world who has attained stability of the country, endowed with the seven gems. That is: The wheel gem, the elephant gem, the horse gem, the jewel gem, the woman gem, the head of household gem, with the counsellor gem as the seventh. He has more than a thousand sons who are courageous, heroic, crushing the armies of others. He dwells having conquered by the Dhamma this earth bounded by the ocean without rod, without sword. If however, he goes forth from the home life into homelessness, then he becomes an arahant, a supremely awakened one, who rolls back the veil in the world. But where, O Master Keṇiya, is Master Gotama, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, dwelling at present?" When thus was said, Keniya,

the matted hair ascetic, having stretched forth his arm downwards, said this to the brahmin Sela: “By this role of dark green forest, O Master Sela.”

atha kho selassa brāhmaṇassa etadahosi: gho-
sopi kho eso dullabho lokasmiṃ yadidaṃ buddhoti.
āgatāni kho panasmākaṃ mantesu dvattiṃsa ma-
hāpurisalakkhaṇāni, yehi samannāgatassa mahā-
purisassa dveva⁴ gatiyo bhavanti anaññā. sace
agāraṃ ajjhāvasati, rājā hoti cakkavattī dhammiko
dhammarājā cāturanto vijitāvī janapadatthāvari-
yappatto sattaratanasamannāgato. tassimāni satta
ratanāni bhavanti. seyyathidaṃ: cakkaratanaṃ
hatthiratanam assaratanam maṇiratanam itthira-
tanam gahapatiratanam parināyakaratanameva
sattamaṃ. parosahassaṃ kho panassa puttā bha-
vanti sūrā viraṅgarūpā parasenappamaddanā. so
imaṃ paṭhavim sāgarapariyantam adaṇḍena asat-
thena dhammena abhivijīya ajjhāvasati. sace pana
agāraṃ anagāriyaṃ pabbajati, araham hoti sam-
māsambuddho loke vivaṭṭacchado¹ kham pana
bho keṇiya, etarahi so bhavam gotamo viharati
araham sammāsambuddho’ti. evaṃ vutte keṇiyo
jaṭilo dakkhiṇam bāhum paggahevā selam brāh-
maṇam etadavoca: yenesā bho sela nīlavanarājī’ti.

6. Then the brahmin Sela, together with three hundred brahmin students, visited with the Auspicious One. Then the brahmin Sela addressed those students: “Be quiet,

venerables. Approach putting your feet down step by step. Indeed difficult to meet with are those Auspicious Ones, like lions, faring alone, and when I am discussing with the samana, Master Gotama, do not you, venerable ones, interrupt us in the middle of our conversation. The venerable ones should wait for me to finish the conversation.”

atha kho selo brāhmaṇo tīhi māṇavakasatehi saddhiṃ yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami. atha kho selo brāhmaṇo te māṇavake āmantesi: appasaddā bhonto āgacchantu pāde pādaṃ² nikkhipantā, durāsadā hi te bhagavanto sīhāva ekacarā, yadā cāhaṃ bho samaṇena gotamena saddhiṃ manteyyaṃ, mā me bhonto antarantarā kathaṃ opātetha, kathāpariyosānaṃ me bhavanto āgamentū’ti.

7. Then the brahmin Sela, approached the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, he exchanged friendly greetings with the Auspicious One. Having exchange friendly greetings and cordial talk, he sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the brahmin Sela looked for the thirty two auspicious marks of a great man on the Auspicious One’s body. The brahmin Sela saw on the Auspicious One’s body most of the thirty two auspicious marks of a great man except for two. Among these two auspicious marks of a great man he had perplexity, doubt, indecision, uncertainty, “the male organ enclosed in sheath, and the largeness of the tongue.” Then for the Auspicious

One this occurred: This brahmin Sela sees most of the thirty two auspicious marks of a great man on me except for two. Among these two auspicious marks of a great man he has perplexity, doubt, indecision, uncertainty, “the male organ enclosed in sheath, and the largeness of the tongue.” So then the Auspicious One perform such an exhibition of superhuman powers that the brahmin Sela saw the Auspicious One’s male organ enclosed in a sheath. Then the Auspicious One, having put out his tongue, touched and stroked both ear holes and also touched and stroked both nostrils. He also covered the entire forehead with his tongue.

atha kho selo brāhmaṇo yena bhagavā tenupa-
saṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavatā saddhiṃ sam-
modi. sammodanīyaṃ kathaṃ sārāṇīyaṃ vītisā-
retvā ekamantaṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ nisinno kho
selo brāhmaṇo bhagavato kāye dvattiṃsa mahā-
purisalakkhaṇāni sammannesī³. addasā kho selo
brāhmaṇo bhagavato kāye dvattiṃsa mahāpuri-
salakkhaṇāni yebhuyyena ṭhapetvā dve. dvīsu ma-
hāpurisalakkhaṇesu kaṅkhati vicikicchati nādhi-
muccati na sampasīdati, kosohite ca vatthaguyhe
pahūtajivhatāya cā’ti. atha kho bhagavato etada-
hosi: passati kho me ayaṃ selo brāhmaṇo dvat-
tiṃsa mahāpurisalakkhaṇāni yebhuyyena ṭhape-
tvā dve. dvīsu mahāpurisalakkhaṇesu kaṅkhati
vicikicchati nādhimuccati na sampasīdati, koso-
hite ca vatthaguyhe, pahūtajivhatāya cāti. atha
kho bhagavā tathārūpaṃ iddhābhisāṅkhāraṃ abhi-

saṅkhāsi yathā addasa selo brāhmaṇo bhagavato kosohitaṃ vatthaguyhaṃ. atha kho bhagavā jivhaṃ ninnāmetvā ubhopi kaṇṇasotāni anumasi parimasi⁴ ubhopi nāsikāsotāni⁵ anumasi parimasi. kevalampi⁶ lalāṭamaṇḍalaṃ⁷ jivhāya chādesi.

8. So then this occurred to the brahmin Sela: “The samana Gotama is endowed with the thirty two auspicious marks of a great man, fully complete, not incomplete, but I don’t know if he is a Buddha or not. But I have heard this said by brahmins of old, of ancient times, teachers of teachers: Those arahants, the supremely awakened ones, manifest themselves when their own praises are being expounded. What if I were to praise the samana Gotama in his presence with fitting verses?”

atha kho selassa brāhmaṇassa etadahosi: saman-nāgato kho samaṇo gotamo dvattiṃsa mahāpurisalakkaṇehi paripuṇṇehi, no aparipuṇṇehi, no ca kho naṃ jānāmi buddho vā no vā. sutam kho pana metaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ vuddhānaṃ mahallakānaṃ ācariyapācariyānaṃ bhāsamānānaṃ. ye te bhavanti arahanto sammāsambuddhā, te sake vaṇṇe bhaññaṃāne attānaṃ pātukaronti. yannū-nāhaṃ samaṇaṃ gotamaṃ sammukhā sārubbhāhi gāthāhi abhitthaveyya’nti.

9. So then the brahmin Sela praised the Auspicious One in his presence with fitting verses.

atha kho selo brāhmaṇo bhagavantam sammukhā
sāruppāhi gāthāhi abhitthavi.

With a perfect body, handsome, well-born,
lovely to behold,
with a golden-colored complexion, the Aus-
picious One is heroic, with extremely
white teeth.

paripuṇṇakāyo suruci sujāto cārudassano,
suvanṇavanṇosi bhagavā susukkadāṭhosi
viriyavā¹

Indeed for a man who is well born, those to
whom distinctive marks come to be,
all those auspicious marks of a great man are
on your body.

narassa hi sujātassa ye bhavanti viyañ-
janā,
¹²sabbe te tava kāyasmim mahāpurisa-
lakkhaṇā.

With bright eyes, handsome face, broad, straight,
majestic,
amidst the sangha of samanas, you shine like
the sun.

pasannanetto sumukho brahā³ uju patā-

pavā,
majjhe samaṇasaṅghassa ādiccova viro-
casi.

A bhikkhu good to gaze upon, with skin like
gold,
what have you to do with being a samana,
with such supreme complexion?

kalyāṇadassano bhikkhu kañcanasanni-
bhattaco,
kinte samaṇabhāvena evaṃ uttamavaṇ-
ṇino.

You are worthy to be a king, a wheel turning
monarch, the foremost leader,
victorious ruler of the earth bounded by the
four oceans.

rājā arahasi bhavituṃ cakkavattī rathe-
sabho,
cāturanto vijitāvī jambusaṇḍassa⁴ issaro.

A khattiya enjoying sovereignty, let them be
your vassals,
king of kings, lord of men, Gotama, claim your
kingdom.

khattiyā bhogī rājāno⁵ anuyuttā⁶ bha-
vantu te,

rājābhirājā manujindo rajjaṃ kārehi go-
tama.

“A king am I, O Sela,” the king of Dhamma
unsurpassed,
I roll the wheel of Dhamma, the wheel that
cannot be rolled back.

rājāhamasmi selā’ti dhammarājā anuttaro,
dhammena cakkam vattemi cakkam ap-
pativattiyam⁷.

He acknowledges supreme awakening, the king
of Dhamma unsurpassed,
I roll the wheel of Dhamma, thus speaks Go-
tama.

sambuddho paṭijānāsi dhammarājā anut-
taro,
dhammena cakkam vattemi iti bhāsasi
gotama.

Who is your general, the venerable disciple
who emulates the Teacher,
Who is your successor, that continues to roll
the wheel of the Dhamma for you?

ko nu senāpati bhoto sāvako satthuran-
vayo⁸,

ko te imaṃ anuvatteti⁹ dhammacakkaṃ
pavattitaṃ.

By me the wheel is set in motion, the wheel of
Dhamma unsurpassed,
Sariputta keeps it rolling, following the exam-
ple of the Tathagata.

mayā pavattitaṃ cakkaṃ (selāti bhagavā)
dhammacakkaṃ anuttaraṃ,
sāriputto anuvatteti anujāto tathāgataṃ.

What should be supremely known is supremely
known, what should be enculturated is
enculturated,
What should be abandoned is abandoned by
me. Therefore, O brahmin, I am a Bud-
dha.

abhiññeyyaṃ abhiññātaṃ bhāvetabbañca
bhāvitaṃ,
pahātabbaṃ pahīnaṃ me tasmā buddhosmi
brāhmaṇa.

Remove your doubt in me, be decisive, O brah-
min,
always difficult to gain is the sight of the supremely
awakened ones.

vinayassu mayi kaṅkhaṃ adhimuccassu

brāhmaṇa,
dullabhaṃ dassanaṃ hoti sambuddhānaṃ
abhiṇhaso.

Truly of those whose appearance is always
difficult to gain in the world,
that I am, O brahmin, the supremely awakened
one, the unsurpassed surgeon.

yesaṃ ve dullabho loke pātubhāvo abhiṇ-
haso,
sohaṃ brāhmaṇa sambuddho sallakatto
anuttaro.

An embodiment of Brahma, unrivalled, crusher
of Mara's army,
having overpowered all enemies, I rejoice with
nothing to fear from any quarter.

brahmabhūto atitulo mārasenappamad-
dano,
sabbāmitte¹⁰ vasī katvā modāmi akuto-
bhayo.

Listen to this, O honorables, as the one en-
dowed with eyes speaks,
the surgeon, the great hero, like a lion roaring
in the forest.

imaṃ bhonto nisāmetha yathā bhāsati

cakkhumā,
sallakatto mahāvīro sīhova nadatī vane.

An embodiment of Brahma, unrivalled, crusher
of Mara's army,
who having seen would not gain confidence,
except one born of dark [nature].

brahmabhūtaṃ atitulaṃ mārasenappa-
maddanaṃ,
ko disvā nappasīdeyya api kaṇhābhijā-
tiko.

He who wishes should follow me, he who does
not wish should go,
here I will go forth, in the presence of the one
with excellent wisdom .

yo maṃ icchati anvetu yo vānicchati gac-
chatu,
idhāhaṃ pabbajissāmi varapaññassa san-
tike.

If the instructions of this supremely awakened
one pleases the master,
we too will go forth, in the presence of the one
with excellent wisdom.

etañce¹² ruccati bhoto sammāsambud-
dhasāsaṇaṃ²,

mayampi pabbajissāma varapaññassa santike.

These three hundred brahmins request with
hands in anjali,
we will fare, O Auspicious One, the life of
purity in your presence.

brāhmaṇā tisatā ime yācanti pañjalikatā,
brahmacariyaṃ carissāma bhagavā tava
santike.

“Well-proclaimed is life of purity, visible here
and now, not involving time,
where the going forth is not empty for one
who trains with vigilance.”

svākkhātaṃ brahmacariyaṃ (selāti bhagavā) sandiṭṭhikamakālikam,
yattha amoghā pabbajjā appamattassa
sikkhatoti.

12. Then the brahmin Sela together with his assembly gained the going forth in the presence of the Auspicious One, they gained the higher ordination. Then with the passing of the night, Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, having prepared excellent hard foods and soft foods in his own hermitage, announced to the Auspicious One: “It is time Master Gotama, the meal is ready.” So then in

the morning, the Auspicious One having dressed, having taken bowl and robe, approached Keniya, the matted hair ascetic's hermitage. Upon arrival, he sat down on a prepared seat with the bhikkhu sangha.

alattha kho selo brāhmaṇo sapaṇiso bhagavato santike pabbajjaṃ, alattha upasampadaṃ. atha kho keṇiyo jaṭilo tassā rattiyaṃ accayena sake asame paṇītaṃ khādanīyaṃ bhojanīyaṃ paṭiyādāpetvā bhagavato kālaṃ ārocāpesi: 'kālo bho gotama, niṭṭhitaṃ bhatta'nti. atha kho bhagavā pubbaṇhasamayāṃ nivāsetvā pattacīvaraṃ ādāya yena keṇiyassa jaṭilassa assamo tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā paññatte āsane nisīdi saddhiṃ bhikkhusaṅghena.

13. So then Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, with his own hands, served and satisfied the community of bhikkhus headed by the Buddha with excellent hard foods and soft foods. Then, when the Auspicious One had eaten and removed his hand from the bowl, Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, having taken a certain lower seat, sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the Auspicious One rejoiced in Keniya, the matted hair ascetic's [generosity] with these verses.

atha kho keṇiyo jaṭilo buddhapamukhaṃ³ bhikkhusaṅghaṃ paṇītena khādanīyena bhojanīyena sahatthā santappesi sampavāresi. atha kho ke-

ṇiyo jaṭilo bhagavantam bhuttāvim onītapattapā-
 ṇim aññataram nīcam āsanam gahetvā ekaman-
 tam nisīdi. ekamantam nisinnam kho keṇiyam ja-
 ṭilam bhagavā imāhi gāthāhi anumodi.

“The fire-oblation is the cheif of sacrifices, the
 metre is the chief of verses,
 the king is the chief of humans, the ocean is
 the chief of rivers.

agghihuttamukhā yaññā sāvittī chandaso
 mukhaṃ,
 rājā mukhaṃ manussānam nadīnam sā-
 garo mukhaṃ.

The moon is the cheif of the constellation, the
 sun is the chief of luminaries,
 for those seeking merits, the sangha is indeed
 the chief of [recipients of] sacrifice.”

nakkhattānam mukhaṃ cando ādicco ta-
 patam mukhaṃ,
 puññaṃ ākaṅkhamānānam saṅgho ve ya-
 jataṃ mukha’nti.

14. Then the Auspicious One, having rejoiced in [the
 generosity of] Keniya, the matted hair ascetic, with these
 verses, having risen up from his seat, departed. Then
 the venerable Sela, together with his assembly, dwelling
 alone, withdrawn, vigilant, ardent, resolute, not long

entered upon and dwelled in that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with their own supreme knowledge in just this very life. They understood: “Destroyed is birth, lived is the life of purity, done is what had to be done, there is nothing else [to do] for thusness.” And the venerable Sela, together with his assembly, all became one of the arahants.

atha kho bhagavā keṇiyaṃ jaṭilaṃ imāhi gāthāhi anumoditvā uṭṭhāyāsanā pakkāmi. atha kho āyasmā selo sapaṛiso eko vūpakaṭṭho appamatto ātāpī pahitatto viharanto na cirasseva yassathāya kula-puttā sammadeva agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajanti. tadanuttaraṃ brahmacariyapariyosānaṃ diṭṭheva dhamme sayamaṃ abhiññā sacchikatvā upasampajja vihāsi. khīṇā jāti, vusitaṃ brahmacariyaṃ, kataṃ karaṇiyaṃ, nāparaṃ itthattāyāti abhaññāsi. aññataro ca kho panāyasmā selo sapaṛiso arahataṃ ahosi.

15. Then the venerable Sela, together with his assembly, approached the Auspicious One. Having approached, having arranged his robe on one shoulder, having stretched out his hands in anjali towards the Auspicious One, addressed the Auspicious One in verses.

atha kho āyasmā selo sapaṛiso yena bhagavā te-

nupasaṅkami, upasaṅkamtivā ekaṃsaṃ cīvaram
katvā yena bhagavā tenaṅjalimpaṇāmetvā bhaga-
vantaṃ gāthāya ajjhabhāsi.

“It is the eighth day since having gone to the
one endowed with eyes as refuge.
For seven days, we have been tamed by your
instructions, O Auspicious One.

yantaṃ saraṇamāgama ito aṭṭhamī cak-
khumā¹,
sattarattena² bhagavā dantaṃhā³ tava
sāsane.

You are the Buddha, you are the Teacher, you
are the sage, vanquisher of Mara,
you having cut the underlying tendencies, crossed,
you lead the population across.

tvaṃ buddho tvaṃ satthā tvaṃ mā-
rābhibhū muni,
tvaṃ anusaye chetvā tiṇṇo tāresimaṃ
pajaṃ.

Those who overcome ownership, those who
split asunder the asavas,
like a lion without undertakings, having aban-
doned fear and dread.

upadhī te samatikkantā āsavā te padā-

litā,
 sīhova anupādāno pahīnabhayabheravo.

These three hundred bhikkhus, stand with
 hands in anjali,
 stretch out your feet, O hero, [let them] pay
 homage to the Teacher, the Naga.”

bhikkhavo tisatā ime tiṭṭhanti pañjalīkatā,
 pāde vīra pasārehi nāgā vandantu sat-
 thuno’ti.

